

ADVENTURE PACK DCC DAY 2025

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INTRODUCTION



he Fall of Al-Razi is a 1st-level adventure for 4-6 PCs using the Dungeon Crawl Classics role-playing game. The adventure begins with the party receiving a quest from a forlorn spirit. To complete the quest, the party will first need to traverse a mysterious cave to retrieve the waters of an enchanted pool. In the final encounter, the party will use the water to rescue the spirit as it takes part in a fairy parade. An endeavor gravely complicated by the mundane parade taking place at the same time.

In between the adventure's three locations, there is overland travel. As written, the party will travel for only a few hours and have a night of rest either after the cave of the pool (area 1-7) or in the village of the parade (area 2). The judge may opt to change this timing and include overland encounters as desired. It should also be noted that the party will need water skins to carry the magic water, though they may be able to trade for them in the cave.

BACKGROUND

Al-Razi was a knight of some renown who perished in an unfortunate fall from his horse. The Fairy Queen, Vanushé, took a liking to him and cheated death. Every seven years, she pays a tithe to Hell to keep him with her.

The spirit of Al-Razi haunts his former abode in an enchanted forest (see Encounter 1). The roses that grow there are infused with power of his ghostly presence. The party, either during their previous exploits or through some trusted oracle, has learned of the healing power of these flowers. Our story opens with the party finding the magic roses.

ENCOUNTER 1: THE ENCHANTED FOREST

The soft, mossy ground of this shady forest partially conceals the ancient ruins which seem to wait just below the surface. A rare patch of sunlight illuminates a lone rose bush. Fluorescent orange roses sing with color.

There are 2d3 roses, and each provides 1d3 points of healing to whoever chooses to eat them. If anyone picks one of the rose, read the following:

The phantom of a shining knight rises from the ground. From atop his lanky frame, a wizened mien betrays a life of suffering.

"Who would presume to come uninvited into my home?"

Initially apprehensive, Al-Razi becomes curious about these interlopers.

"I perceive that you are a cohort of some capability. What is it that you desire in this life or the next?"

"My resources may assist you if you but help me. Gold, arcane knowledge, and my steel are yours. I ask only that you rescue me from my terrible imprisonment."

Page 2

"My name is Al-Razi and I was once a great knight. A trick of the fairy queen, Vanushé, led to a moment of terrible ill fortune. I fell from my horse, but she caught me and stole me from death. Every seven years she pays a tithe to hell to keep me with her."

"Tomorrow evening the fairy parade will take place. The parade route moves between two stones that are on either side of a nearby village. I will ride a black horse at the head of the parade. Come to my horse and catch me. If you drop me, it will mean my doom. If you catch me and hold me, I can join you in this world."

There is one slight difficulty. As mortals, you cannot see or touch this parade. You must retrieve the waters of an enchanted pool from a nearby cave. At the time of the parade, wet your eyes with the water, and you will behold the fairies.

Al-Razi imparts the needed directions to both the cave and the village of Taribat where the parade will be held and fades away. "I can remain here with you only so long," he intones and is gone.

AREA 1: THE TWILIGHT CAVE

Area 1-1-Cave Mouth: *The giant gaping mouth of the cave arcs over the flat, wet land. Some 60' back the cave shrinks to a small opening lined with crystals like a massive geode. They scintillate with the full spectrum of colors shining up from the room below.*

A hardscabble climb down and the crystalline tunnel opens into a natural hall of pillars.

Area 1-2—The Rainbow Room: *Prismatic, natural crystal columns reach up from the floor, piercing the ceiling of the cave and continuing up through the living rock to daylight. The sun slams down through the veins of light, etching the walls and floors with a blanket of rainbows. Only a lone archway, circumscribed by two sets of runes, creates a dark void against the far wall.*

While a spectacular sight, there is no magic in this room aside from the portal. The natural crystal pillars travel up through the earth to the top of the surrounding hill and carry sunlight down which is refracted into rainbows.

If they look through the archway, read the following:

Through the archway is the mirror image of this room, but devoid of luminescence. Black crystal pillars puncture a mirror-smooth floor. The image ripples as if you are peering at a mirage.

This portal reflects matter as a mirror reflects light. Anything or anyone poked through the barrier comes out on this side as if it were being pressed through from the other side. A person stepping through the field finds themselves in the same spot and facing the other direction, so they cannot get through the door.

They are unchanged by this, save for a single dramatic difference. What was left is now right, as if in a mirror. This would be only a cosmetic change except that, from their perspective, it is the world that is mirrored while they remain unchanged. Righting this strange malady requires only stepping once more through the pellucid barrier.



The two sets of runes surrounding the door seem strange and muddled. A wizard, elf, or thief may read each set with a DC 20 Intelligence check. All others must use a d10 for the check. Passing through the portal and reading the runes, or using a mirror to view them, makes the runes automatically readable by wizards elves, or thieves, and a standard DC 10 Intelligence check for all others.

The runes read “As you leave, so you enter” and “You are welcome to tread farewell.” Anyone walking through the portal backwards is not reversed. They move on to the next room and slide away on the slippery floor.

Area 1-3—Fey Foyer: *Jet-black crystal pillars gleam in the glare of the neighboring room. The air buzzes with tiny sparks that flit about playfully. A wooden door on the far wall features a giant mouth that would seem to be a relief carved into the wood of the door, but it gives a deep laugh and exposes a dark gullet.*

The black floor of this room is nearly frictionless creating an effect on the PCs approximating a weightless environment. Dwarves may be able to discern this from a distance with a DC 10 Intelligence check. Falling on this floor is so sudden it causes 1 point of damage.

The first person to step on it immediately falls and continues sliding with whatever momentum they have. The following PCs to step on the floor must pass a DC 15 Reflex save to keep their footing. They slide forward whatever the result. Taking any action on the floor, without some form of support, requires a DC 15 Reflex save to remain standing.

The sparks that flit through the air are minuscule fairies.

They rob one random coin (cp, sp, gp, etc.) from everyone in the room each round. The spark pulls the coin from its location, breaking any binding, and feeds it to the mouth in the door. PCs may make a DC 15 Agility or *pick pockets* check to resist but fail if they fail. These tiny fairies are the Door God’s friends.

If a PC approaches the door, a wooden foot kicks them away (Atk melee +4, 1d6 damage from colliding with the far wall). Any PC offering money to the door is unmolested, and the door opens for them if they feed it. Either way, the door is always unlocked, though it does close on its own.

A judge wishing to complete this adventure in a single session may opt not to have the door come to life, and have the door simply open after it has been fed. After the door has eaten 10 stolen coins, the boards of the door creak out into four legs. It can walk normally across the floor and tries to shove the PCs back through the entryway. It does not leave this room.

Door God: Atk kick +4 melee (shove); Crit M/d8; AC 14; HD 4d8 (hp 18); MV 30’ or climb 20’; Act 1d20; SP shove, splinter; SV Fort +4, Ref +0, Will -2; AL L.

Shove: A kick sends the target speeding away with such force that they take 1d6 damage upon hitting any wall or pillar.

Splinter: Any attack that creates splinters and causes greater than 3 hp of damage, creates a new Door God with as many hit points as the attack caused. Killing blows that would cause splinters, split the Door God in two, with each half having half the hit points. Attacks that cause additional

damage rolls, such as some critical hits, create additional creatures for each damage die rolled. These splinters come to life during the original Door God's next action.

Area 1-4—The Fey Valley: *The door opens to the chill night air of a forest clearing. A dark valley opens before you, completely black but for a narrow path shining down through the emptiness. Dark pine trees cut a jagged line across an ultraviolet sky.*

To one side of the clearing, a family of rotund house cats, as large as bears, relaxes. One large adult lies with a kitten the size of a bear cub, while the other stares at you with a blank expression. The parents wear jeweled collars studded with large gems.

At the clearing exit, and blocking the way forward, four more kittens play with a frightened mouse.

The parents only give a bored meow as a response and hiss if the party moves closer. The kittens are wary of people. The cats do not move unless they are attacked from a distance and strike if anyone comes too near. The kittens ignore the PCs unless they get too close or try to intervene with their tormenting of the mouse. Anyone harming a kitten causes the adult cats to attack.

A DC 13 Personality check or an offering of food will convince the kittens to leave the mouse alone and return to their parents, allowing the party to exit this area without violence. PCs with appropriate occupations gains a +1d bonus to the Personality check.

Anyone entering the surrounding forest is instantly disoriented. They wander randomly rolling 1d4 each round and, on a roll of 1, exit again near to where they entered.

Cat (2): Init +5; Atk paw +3 melee (rodent curse); Crit M/d8; AC 14; HD 2d8 (hp 9 each); MV 35' or climb 25'; Act 1d20; SP infravision 60', rodent curse; SV Fort +2, Ref +4, Will +1; AL C.

Rodent curse: Anyone struck by an adult cat is transformed into a mouse, with their armor and gear made tiny (DC 10 Fortitude save to avoid). At the judge's discretion, this curse is effective only in the fey lands. It reverts when the PCs leave, but until the curse is lifted, it is in effect again if they return.

Each cat has a jeweled collar with seven sapphires worth 68 gp each.

Kitten (5): Init +1; Atk paw +1 melee (1d3); Crit M/d6; AC 12; HD 1d8 (hp 4 each); MV 30' or climb 20'; Act 1d16; SP infravision 60'; SV Fort +1, Ref +2, Will -1; AL C.

Bergamont "Bergie" Millford Tumbleton (mouse form): Init +6; Atk tiny sword +4 melee (1); Crit I/d3-1; AC 16; HD 2d6 (hp 10); MV 15' or climb 10'; Act 1d14; SP infravision 60', sense of smell; SV Fort +1, Ref +5, Will +3; AL L.

Anyone looking closely at the mouse notices he is wearing tiny clothes and a rucksack. Bergie was once a human adventurer who stumbled upon the cave and made it into the fairy lands before running afoul of the cats. He will gladly join the party in the hopes of escaping the fairy lands and finding his way home.

Area 1-5—The Gnosees: *The path stretches down through the base of the valley and winds past three figures. The three black-veiled figures have ghost-pale skin and pointed ears. They dance wildly around a glowing green cauldron. They chant a quiet song and, with soft flourishes, introduce unaccountable ingredients into the green mist. One pours smoke from a tiny, red pyramid. Another upsets an ampule of glittering powder that curls downward. They give you a sideways glance but otherwise ignore you.*

These witches are engrossed in their work but may answer a quick question or two. If they are interrogated about their activities, they advise the travelers to move along. Wizards and elves who study their activities may begin to see the clockwork springs of the cosmos momentarily held in abeyance by their machinations. By studying for over 2 hours, a wizard or elf may learn a single 2nd-level spell of their choosing. If they study too long, they begin to see more of the witches' true form, a sight which changes the viewer. Roll on Table 5-3: Minor Corruption (DCC RPG p. 116) to determine the change.

If a witch or their cauldron is hit with a non-magical weapon, the attacker discovers that they have struck themselves (magical weapons do damage as normal). Regardless, they are too busy to trifle with mortals and so, with a glance, they can cause a fey wound to their would-be attacker.

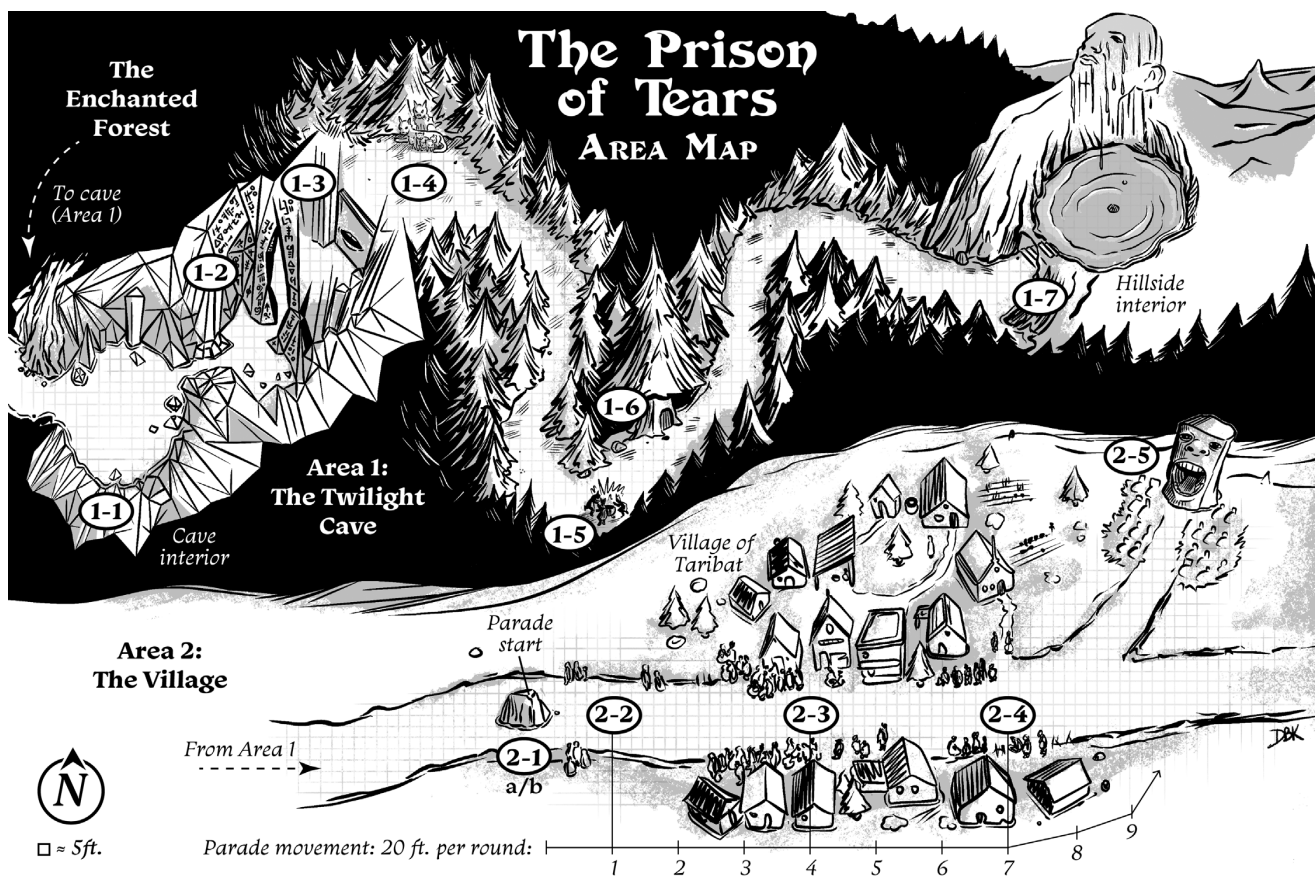
Thieves can risk stealing from the witches with a DC 15 *pick pockets* check. Failure means they see that their hand is now grabbing their shoulder as if their arm was reversed, hand to shoulder. The hand lets go and the arm falls into the witch's pocket and the witch give the thief a kick without turning from their work. The thief may attempt the check again to retrieve their arm and an item taken from the gnosee's pocket. On a successful check, roll 1d20 on Table 1-1 below.

TABLE 1-1: ITEMS TAKEN FROM A GNOSEE'S POCKET

- | | |
|-------|--|
| 1 | The thief is wearing <i>Infridi's Ring</i> — the wearer must steal an item each day or suffer a gnawing hunger that imparts a -2 to Willpower saves. |
| 2-16 | An other-worldly ingredient that can impart +4 to a spell check, in a fantastic container (die roll x 50 gp). |
| 17-19 | <i>The Syringe Dagger</i> — +1 backstab, +1d crit die, -1 fumble die, +3 on any Handle Poison check. |
| 20 | A shard of living cosmic energy that increases the thief's Luck by +1 permanently and "refills" any lost Luck spent today. |

The Gnosees (3): Init d30; Atk kick +12 melee (4d6 subdual) or fey wound (special); Crit DN/d6; AC 12; HD 6d10 (hp 33 each); MV 45' or fly 35'; Act 2d24; SP fey wound, X-ray vision 120'; SV Fort +6, Ref +6, Will +12; AL N.

Fey wound: Any attacker must pass a DC 15 Fortitude save or their arm disappears and the weapon falls away. The would-be assailant's clothes and armor will have been tailored to cover the missing limb. This fey wound exists only in the fey lands and the arm returns when they depart the land but disappears again upon return, unless the curse is lifted.



These beings are only the fingertips of larger creatures poked down into this world. They take no heed of the creatures of this universe. Upon death, they give only a soft “oh my” and twirl languidly away from our reality.

Area 1-6—Ye Old Magic Shoppe: A very large tree stands next to the path. Carved into the trunk is a crude drawing of a life-size door. Above the door, a corpulent beetle illuminates a carved sign, which reads; “Magic Shoppe”.

If the beetle is molested, it sprays the attacker and flies off.

Knocking on the door or calling out causes the carving to become a real door.

A small fellow, smartly dressed and covered in red fur, opens the top half of the door and hops onto a stool.

“Welcome to my shoppe. I am Goodruff, the proprietor.”

Behind him are shelves of objects. There are small portraits, locks of hair, letters, keys, and well-worn tools. Strewn about the floor, and leaning against the walls are far more remarkable items.

The items on the floor are but paltry baubles to Goodruff, but he will not trade them for worthless gold or gems (see Table 1: Magic Shoppe Items). He wants their 0-level goods and any other items that have a history. He bargains hard and will try to take all the PC’s goods for even a single of his items.

The door will revert to a carving at the first hint of chicanery, violence, or witchcraft.

TABLE 1-2: MAGIC SHOPPE ITEMS

1. A folio strapped into an oiled canvas contains 2d3 random 1st-level spells.
2. A spiked shield with a skull motif (inflicts 1d5 damage on a shield bash).
3. A random potion (DCC RPG rulebook, p. 224).
4. A coffin-shaped amulet with two small bones under glass. Grants a +1 bonus to cleric spell checks.
5. A bottle labeled *Lottery Powder*. Burning it and inhaling the fumes imparts a permanent +1 to an ability score of your choice.
6. *Sylphane’s Wondrous Copper Piece*. A halfling may flip this coin 1/day. On a successful toss, it is a lucky day and the halfling immediately regains 1 point of Luck.
7. The -1 magic *Sword of Suffering*. Atk -1 melee (d8+3), +1 crit range, +1d crit die. AL N. Roll of 1 on a crit die inflicts 1d12 damage on the wielder. It is starving for pain.
8. Three sturdy dowels bound with a leather strap. If asked about this item, Goodruff will only say that its use is a secret for the players of a great game.

Ancatrite Beetle: Init -2; Atk pheromone spray (DC 15 Ref save to avoid, range 30'); Crit none; AC 15; HD 2d8+2 (hp 11); MV 30' or fly 20'; Act 1d20; SP pheromone spray; SV Fort +1, Ref +0, Will -3; AL L.

Phermone spray: The beetle's spray stains the target with a glowing stench. It confers -2 to hide checks and fey creatures mistrust the PC. Bathing in chikoo juice removes the stain.

Goodruff: Init +2; Atk hammer -2 melee (1d3); Crit III/d4; AC 13; HD 1d6 (hp 6); MV 20'; Act 1d20; SP psychic attack, immune to sleep and charm, sees through illusion, SV Fort +0, Ref +2, Will +2; AL L.

Psychic attack: inflicts 1d6 Intelligence damage if the target fails a DC 10 Willpower save.

Area 1-7—The Pool: *A cave on the far valley wall glows blue against the black hillside. Inside, stairs expand downwards to the edge of a smooth-bottomed, shallow pool some 70' across. The water glows as if filled with tiny, twinkling stars.*

The waters of this pool when applied to the eyes imbues vision of the fey. These mortals may temporarily see those fey creatures who ride the border between this world and theirs. Bathers in the pool are healed of all injuries and curses but not cursed items. Missing limbs grow back and corruption is reversed. Anyone who wades near the center of the pool finds a circle slightly larger than 1' in diameter. There are two 2" holes in the circle, each 4" deep.

The circular stone can be opened with a DC 15 Strength check. Using some leverage with the holes requires only a DC 10 Strength check and may allow someone else to help for +1d. Using the dowels from the magic shoppe, by inserting two and using the third to twist, opens the catch easily.

The stone reveals a small cavity. Bubbles rise into the air and expand into a giant face that appears to be made of rain. It looks down with gratitude and effervesces into the air.

This is the Spirit of the Pool. Once released, everyone's Luck score increases by +1. They may meet the spirit again by the end of area 2.

AREA 2: THE VILLAGE



he village of Taribat is abuzz with life. People are camped outside of town. Hawkers sell local crafts and treats such as squirrel-in-plum candy. The town square is full of people moving between carts heavy with kegs of mead from the surrounding communities.

People are here for the festival and the parade. This is a mundane parade, and they know nothing of any fairies that are not fairy tales. The villagers say that the meaning of the parade has been lost to time but it takes place every seven years and is given in honor of a queen who must have ruled these lands. The fairy queen is imagined to be a part of the parade, but only as a superstition and a story to scare children.

Nearly every 0-level profession is represented in the village and horses can be rented for 2 sp. The party has time to prepare and to reflect on what the phantom knight told them.

THE PARADE



he parade of villagers and the parade of fairies will merge as the villagers pass the large stone (area 2-1) and the fairies appear out of its face. All the fairies, save the queen and her handmaidens, the paper dolls, will have a human counterpart that will inhabit the same place and follow along with their fairy's actions as long as the behavior can be, somehow, excused in their reality. If it cannot, they will try to rejoin the fey parade as soon as possible. If a villager's mask is removed, they will no longer follow their fairy counterpart.

The parades move at a rate of 20' per round. If the Queen feels threatened, she will quicken the pace to 30'. If she feels mortal danger, the Queen, her handmaidens, the fey riders, and Al-Razi will move at a rate of 45'.

Tracking movement by rounds, the parade takes three rounds to travel through each of the three sections with the mundane parade stopping before the fey parade spends the last round crossing the graveyard (area 2-5). If the Queen has quickened the pace, these may be reduced to two or even one round per section. The fey ceremony must be completed on time and the parade will always move forward.

The Queen's desire for a decorous ceremony is only slightly abated by her rage for those who would seek to interfere. She knows instantly who has the vision of the fey and is canny enough to know who their compatriots are.

The Queen is unlikely to enter melee but she will use her powerful illusions, which affect anyone she chooses, especially against the PCs. She will start casting *wall of fire* while the fey riders, who surround Al-Razi, use their *fey calamities*. The paper dolls prefer to stay with their Queen, but they can quickly be dispatched to a PC if needed. In the town, the fey riders can throw their strangling necklaces. If the PCs manage to break through the circle of riders surrounding Al-Razi, she will cast *stone paxithos* and call her giant to rise from beneath them.

The magic water's effect lasts for three rounds and then must be reapplied. This action can be part of their movement. A PC who cannot see or interact with fairies cannot be targeted by fairies other than the Queen and her paper dolls. Such a PC could interact with the real-world rider and horse and move them away from their fey twin.

Area 2-1a—The Mundane Parade: *As the witching hour approaches, costumed townsfolk begin gathering at a large stone outside of town. Decorated carts, musicians, and all manner of strangely costumed people are preparing here. Caricatures of popes and kings with gruesome faces walk around drinking. There is even a false knight, mounted on a dapple gray horse, wearing costume armor. Seven royal riders wearing dazzling costumes festooned with false gems and gold surround the false knight. Their oversize masks display a haughty mien.*

The tempo of the revelry increases until midnight when all goes silent. The parade begins with a lone flute. The costumed knight starts from the rock, surrounded by the seven royal riders. There is a space behind them and then a costumed mob follows.

If the party does anything to impede the parade, the villagers become irate and go to great lengths to ensure that their parade goes on. They are superstitious, intoxicated, and, other than one fool-hardy child, will not put the enchanted water on their eyes. The villagers cannot conceive of the existence of the fairy parade and see only the party acting strangely.

Peasant (31): Init -2; Atk club -1 melee (1d4-1); Crit I/d4; AC 9; HD 1d4 (hp 3 each); MV 30'; Act 1d20; SV Fort -1, Ref -2, Will -1; AL varies.

Horse (8): Init +1; Atk hoof +2 melee (1d4+2); AC 14; Crit M/d8; HD 3d8 (hp 14 each); MV 60'; Act 1d20; SV Fort +4, Ref +3, Will +1; AL N.

Area 2-1b—The Fairy Parade: Anyone whose eyes have been moistened by the enchanted water sees the fairy parade in their mind's eye and witness the following:

A second parade appears out of the face of the rock and merges with the first parade. This ghostly parade begins with the knight Al-Razi on a black steed and surrounded by seven fey riders. The fey riders appear as bejeweled royalty, but their garments are worn and soiled. They move to take up the same position in space as the earthly riders so that they are mixed into a single form with bits of each poking out.

Following them, a small woman emerges from the rock. She is beautiful and hard. She could be made of branches. Her long gown is held by two, intricately folded, paper dolls. Each has two swords of the thinnest rice paper flapping at their sides. This must be the fairy queen and her handmaidens.

Behind the queen is the mass of costumed peasants and, merging with them, a motley array of grotesques. There are large insects, blue-furred chimpanzees, and bird-like creatures with giant eyes. All wear the clothes of different offices. They merge with the peasants so that they occupy the same space. The odd creatures and their mundane counterpart dance with a dreamlike grace. Some of the villagers join in and seem to partner with the monstrosities

THE PARADE ROUTE

Area 2-2—The Parade Begins: The Queen desires a decorous parade. She will try to block the party with a *wall of fire* illusion. If the party blocks the road or gets too close to the knight, the *stone paxithos* will rise from beneath them and push them to the side. She will continue to use her illusions throughout the parade or until Al-Razi is saved or killed.

Area 2-3—The Town Square: The majority of the parade viewers are here. They call out to the riders; "Throw me something, master!" The earthly riders toss crude costume necklaces to the bemusement of the crowd. The Fey Riders toss their *throw* at anyone who approaches.

Area 2-4—After the Village: The final stone is across a graveyard. The earthly parade ends before the gravestones, while the alien paraders continue to the obelisk at the far end.

The fey parade spends one round in the graveyard without their human counterparts.

Area 2-5—The Parade's End: A giant face appears on the smooth surface of the standing stone. A huge mouth

TABLE 2-1: RANDOM FEY FORM, OFFICE, AND ACTION:

Roll 1d10 on each column to create 1,000 different fairy paraders.

1	Duck	Accountant	Heal (1 HD)
2	Faun	Magistrate	Knife (1d5)
3	Stag	Gongfarmer	Bite (1d6)
4	Tree	Costermonger	Spear (1d8)
5	Snake	Administrator	Shin kick (1d4 damage and hop back 10')
6	Stick Insect	President	Goopy spray (15' cone, DC 15 Reflex save or half movement and -1d penalty to all actions until cleaned off)
7	Grave-stone	Bishop	Dazzling display (DC 15 Willpower save or stunned for 1 round)
8	Child	Sheikh	Small force field (Absorbs 5 hp before dispelling)
9	Elf	Penitent	Fire breath (DC 15 Reflex save or 1d6 fire damage + 1d3/round until extinguished)
10	The floating clothes of a...	Artisan	Grapple + constrict (DC 12 Strength check or 1d4 damage/round)

opens to reveal a road descending downwards. The fey parade will travel down the path with or without the knight. If the party is unable to save Al-Razi, he cries as he leaves this world. Any mortal attempting to follow them smacks into the smooth face of the stone.

Note: A successful hit on a fey may do half or subdual damage on their earthly counterpart depending on the type of weapon used. Attacking the fey with subdual damage does no damage against the earthbound target, but may push them apart.

Fey Creature (31): Init -2; Atk varies +3 (varies); Crit M/d6; AC 9; HD 1d6 (hp 3 each); MV varies; Act 1d20; SP immune to sleep and charm, sees through illusion, fey form; SV Fort -1, Ref -2, Will -1; AL C.

Fey form: Roll on Table 2-1 above to determine appearance and special attack or action.

This motley crew will protect the Queen but otherwise, behave randomly and may even assist a PC.

Fey Rider (7): Init +2; Atk saber +5 melee (1d8+1); Crit III/d8; AC 15; HD 2d8 (hp 7 each); MV 60'; Act 1d20; SP fey calamity, throw, immune to sleep and charm, sees through illusion; SV Fort +2, Ref +4, Will +3; AL C.



Throw: While in town, a fey rider can throw a beaded necklace that wraps around a PC's neck causing 1d5 Stamina damage per round, DC 15 Reflex save to avoid (armor check penalties apply). Removing the necklace requires DC 10 Strength check or an attack against AC 8 with a small blade. The Stamina damage will heal right away once freed, but causes death if it reaches 0.

These creatures do not fight in the normal manner and would seldom think of drawing their weapon except against a direct threat to their queen. Any PC attempting to interact with or pass around a rider becomes the victim of a *fey calamity* (see Table 2-2: *Fey Calamities*). Even those using ranged weapons catch the fey rider's eye before they can take their shot.

The rider's AC and attack bonus are reduced by -1, and movement is reduced by 30' when not mounted on their warhorse. If brought to 0 hp, the fey riders angle their mounts down into the earth and disappear.

Moving through the circle of fey riders to the knight requires a PC's full movement. If a fey rider can be forced away from the knight, a PC may be able to move through the gap unimpeded. The Queen will deploy her paper dolls and further illusions while a fey rider may lash out with a saber.

Fey Warhorse (8): Init +1; Atk hoof +5 melee (1d6+3); Crit M/d10; AC 14; HD 4d8 (hp 18 each); MV 60'; Act 1d20; SP immune to sleep and charm, sees through illusion; SV Fort +6, Ref +4, Will +2; AL N.

Paper Dolls (2): Init +4; Atk paper sword +2 melee (1d6); Crit III/d8; AC 14; HD 2d6 (hp 6 each); MV 45'; Act 2d16; SP paper cut, sees through illusion, sees into mundane world,

vulnerable to water (1d6 damage per splash); SV Fort +1, Ref +3, Will +6; AL C.

Paper cut: Dual swords, twisting in the air, passes through armor as flesh, ignoring any non-magic armor worn. The paper swords quickly become sodden by blood spilled by its attacks. After two successful attacks, a sword become a useless mass of quivering bloody pulp.

These animated dolls are formed of the lightest paper. They flutter in the breeze and dance through the air with exquisite movements until they explode into combat.

Vanushé, The Fey Queen: Init +3; Atk long needle +3 melee (1d8+bleed); Crit DN/d8; AC 15; HD 8d8 (hp 36); MV 30' or fly 45'; Act 1d20; SP bleed, faerie illusions, immune to *sleep* and *charm*, sees through illusion, sees into mundane world; SV Fort +4, Ref +2, Will +5; AL C.

Bleed: Anyone struck with a needle loses blood at the rate of 1d4 hp per round through the hollow needle until they pull it out.

Faerie illusions: Her power allows her to create illusions of exceptional strength. Only those she chooses see the illusion regardless of their *vision of the fey*. People, other than the targets, are unaware of the illusions entirely but avoid them anyway.

These illusions cause damage as normal. The difference is that illusory damage heals as soon as either the illusion dissipates or the PC is reduced to 0 hp. The "dead" PC realizes that it was all an illusion on their next round or if someone attempts to revive them. These are not visual illusions, but ideas implanted deep in the victim's mind.

TABLE 2-2: FEY CALAMITIES

Roll 1d14, modified by Luck on the following table. Cross out each entry as it is rolled, except for 13 and 14. Use the next closest entry instead, preferring a lower entry if possible.

These effects are not illusions but minor curses and may be lifted by the usual means. Many of the calamities last only through the encounter, but some last longer, as noted below.

1. Their nose grows permanently long, granting them a +2 bonus to smell-related checks and cannot be surprised by stinky monsters. Take no action due to shock.*
2. A non-magical weapon becomes a serpent. It strikes immediately. Atk +2 melee (1d4 damage plus poison (DC 15 Fortitude save or lose 1d6 Strength damage.)). PC loses their action.*
3. A cage of fey wood grows around the victim. Inflicting 9 points of damage to it or a successful DC 15 Strength check destroys the cage.
4. Space stretches out in front of the target. They are now 40' back.
5. Target floats an inch off the ground, as if they were nearly neutrally buoyant. Lose their action flailing.
6. Target can speak only in rhyme. Lose their action in shock.
7. Pants are on fire, causing 1d6 damage per round. A DC 15 Agility check to extinguishes the fire.
8. Covered in spiders. Target suffers a -1d penalty to all actions until they remove their armor.
9. Target's clothes and armor fall off, leaving them in their underclothes. Target must make a DC 15 Reflex save or trip over their pants.
10. It begins to rain, but only on the target and follows them wherever they go. They suffer a -1 penalty on Reflex saves or to catch things until the curse ends.
11. Curse of Befuddlement. There is a 50% chance the target does the exact opposite of what they intend each round (*judge's discretion if what the opposite action would be is unclear*).
12. Victim cannot stop dancing. Moving at other than half speed requires them to describe their dance moves.
13. The calamity fails. The fey rider looks disappointed.
14. Calamitous feedback. The fey rider is destroyed.

*The curse remains after the encounter.

Being killed by an illusion imbues a PC with the ability to make DC 15 Willpower saves (elves roll a d30) against all of the Queen's illusions. This includes both walking through the illusions and being attacked by the giant.

The Queen creates two additional illusions when Al-Razi falls from the horse (see *Catching Al-Razi* below).

Wall of Fire: Jets of white-hot gas erupt from the ground, creating a wall of fire. Any creature passing through the flames takes 1d6 damage and catches fire (1d4 damage per round, DC 15 Agility check to put out the flames).

Gorge of Shards: Chasms open up in the ground filled with crystal spikes. A DC 15 Agility check (armor check penalties apply) is required to jump across. Falling in causes 1d7 damage and another 1d3 to climb out unassisted.

Stone Paxithos: The ground is pushed up from below into a mound. A gray hulk steps out of the earth (see stat block below).

The Queen can see and interact with the mundane world. She knows when anyone has the *vision of the fey* and will do all she can to stop Al-Razi from being saved. She attacks those without the *vision of the fey* at +2 as she is, effectively, invisible. If she has taken no action this round, she strikes first at anyone who attempts a melee attack.

Stone Paxithos (10' tall, 500 lbs.): Init +1; Atk club +5 melee (1d8+2 plus slam); Crit M/d10; AC 16; HD 4d8+4 (hp 22); MV 20'; Act 1d20; SP infravision, shockwave; SV Fort +4, Ref +2, Will +2; AL N

Shockwave: As an action, Stone Paxithos may slam its club into the ground, requiring all party members within 30' to pass a DC 10 Reflex save or fall prone.

Slam: The target is thrown 10' and must pass a DC 15 Reflex save or fall prone.

CATCHING AL-RAZI



PC need only stand next to Al-Razi and reach up for him to fall into their arms. The PC must make a DC 10 Agility check or a melee attack vs. AC 10 to catch him. Fail, and nearby PCs may make a DC 15 Agility check to dive in and catch him.

When he lands in their arms, he transforms into a giant, hairy ant. The PC is caught by another one of the Queen's illusions, and the bug gets a free (illusory) attack.

In the next round, Al-Razi changes into a giant, hot coal. The holder must make a DC 10 Agility check to juggle him in the air or take 1d8 points of illusionary damage. Nearby PCs may attempt to catch him.

In the following round, he is back human and saved. If he is dropped before this point, he is human but dead.

Al-Razi (human): Init +3; Atk sword +4 melee (1d8+2); Crit I/d4; AC 18; HD 1d4+2 (hp 4); MV 30'; Act 1d20; SV Fort +1, Ref +2, Will +5; AL L.

Al-Razi (ant): Init +2; Atk bite +4 melee (1d8, illusory); Crit M/d8; AC 18; HD 3d8+6 (hp 19); MV 50' or climb 50'; Act 1d20; SV Fort +7, Ref +3, Will -3; AL L.

THE SPIRIT OF THE POOL

If the party has released the spirit of the pool, it will appear at a dramatic moment.

The spirit of the enchanted pool rises once more above you. With a soft “thank you,” a rain of magic water falls on everyone. The crowd gasps at the terrible sight of the fairies, and the earthly parade scatters.

This may occur during the final leg of the parade or whenever the judge wishes. The rainfall destroys the paper dolls and causes the earthly parade and parade goers to flee in fear of the terrible sight.

ENCOUNTER CHEAT SHEET

Important: Do not let the PCs pass the circle of riders until the climax.

Magic Water: Moistening one’s eyes bestows the ability to see and interact with the fairies for three rounds. It also allows the faeries to interact with the PCs as well.

The Queen and her handmaidens: Can interact with the real world regardless of the magic water. The PCs actions will trigger the Queen’s illusions. The handmaidens swords ignore armor.

The Queen’s Illusions: These cause illusory damage which heals when the PC reaches 0 hp. The usual effects of reaching 0 hp are ignored. A PC who has undergone this death is imbued with the ability to make DC 15 Willpower saves (elves roll a d30) against all of the Queen’s illusions.

The Fey Riders: They surround Al-Razi. Moving into the ring of riders requires a PC’s full movement. Any attempt to interact with Al-Razi or the riders is met with a fey calamity.

CONCLUDING THE ADVENTURE



If the party was unable to rescue Al-Razi they have failed their mission. The townspeople may think their behavior strange, but they are, for the most part, inebriated and forgiving. In the event of a total party kill, the villagers may attempt to roll the body of any fallen party members.

If the party drops Al-Razi, his corpse remains as the fairy parade moves on alone. The Queen bestows the curse of *thoughtless fortune* on the party. Each PC has a -2 on all Willpower saves until the curse is lifted. The village is in awe and realizes the party has undergone a terrible journey. This may seem like a failure, but the party has succeeded freeing Al-Razi from his imprisonment. Read the following passage:

The phantom stands before you once again. “I am saddened I cannot join you in your forthcoming adventures, but you have saved me from my endless torment. I thank you with all my heart.” The spirit directs you to his treasure and disappears forever.

If they catch and hold Al-Razi, they become heroes of the surrounding area. Al-Razi may become a player’s character, ready to level with 10 XP. Regardless of the character class his player chooses, Al-Razi uses the warrior’s attack modifier and Might Deeds of Arms class ability for their respective level.

Whether corporeal or not, Al-Razi leads the party to a buried, stone cache near his ruins. Inside an oiled canvas bundle is, 120 ep, a tome of 2d5 1st-level spells and a single 2nd-level spell, and a silver comb (20 gp).



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Cover and frontispiece artist: Chuck Whelon • Art direction & layout: Matt Hildebrand

Developer: Michael Curtis • Publisher: Joseph Goodman

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Writer: Ariel Churi • Editor: Rev. Dak J Ultimak

Cartographer: Davin Kluttz • Interior Artists: Alex Coggon, Doug Kovacs, Brad McDevitt.

Playtesters: Greg McNabb, nonPerson, Daniel Beltran-Villegas, Edward Pelikan, Dave Campbell, Kate Schleigh, Michael Schleigh, Christopher Messemore, Frank Ortega, Travis Rapp, and, Billy Fleming, Tom “Melvis Pestly” Hood, bygrinstow, Jim “paxoniseki” Cox, @subservient_latte.

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Balticrawl Blitz

Writer: James M. Spahn • Editor: Rev. Dak Ultimak

Cartographer: Will McAusland • Interior Artists: Joe Abboreno, Brad McDevitt

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